AI BUSINESS EXPERT · BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE

Executive Content — Intelligent Automation Wins: Where the Returns Are Real

Date: 20 March 2026

Classification: Internal Use Only

88%	6%	3×	40%
OF ORGS DEPLOY AI IN AT LEAST ONE FUNCTION	CAN ATTRIBUTE >5% OF EBIT TO AI	MORE LIKELY TO SUCCEED WITH PROCESS REDESIGN FIRST	OF ENTERPRISE APPS WITH EMBEDDED AI AGENTS BY 2026

Version A — With Citations

Variant 1: C-Suite Brief

Intelligent automation has moved from pilot to production. The companies delivering measurable results share one characteristic: they redesigned workflows, not just the tools running them.

What Is Happening

88% of organisations now deploy AI in at least one business function (McKinsey & Company, 2025). The ones achieving measurable impact — only 39% at enterprise level — treated automation as infrastructure requiring governance, data quality investment, and workflow redesign, not a software rollout.

The Numbers That Matter

- **JPMorgan Chase**: 360,000 legal hours saved per year via COiN contract review (ABA Journal, 2023)
- **BBVA**: 2.8 hours/week saved per employee across 120,000 staff; 80% efficiency gains in legal workflows (OpenAI, 2025)
- **Allianz Australia**: Food spoilage claims — 7 days → under 1 day via Project Nemo (Allianz, 2025)
- **Microsoft Power Automate**: 248% ROI over 3 years; payback under 6 months (Forrester/Microsoft, 2024)
- **Walmart**: USD 55 million saved via Self-Healing Inventory (Logistics Viewpoints, 2025)
- **UPS ORION**: 100 million delivery miles eliminated per year (logistics industry sources)

The Risk You Cannot Ignore

95% of enterprise generative AI pilots fail to deliver measurable P&L impact — primarily due to fragmented data, legacy integration complexity, and absent governance (MIT study, as reported by Fortune, 2025). Gartner predicts 40%+ of agentic AI projects will be cancelled by end of 2027 (Gartner, June 2025).

Your Three Questions

1. Do we have a data quality programme underway ahead of automation deployment?
2. Have we identified our three highest-volume, most repetitive processes as automation candidates?
3. Is our governance framework for AI decision-making documented and tested?

Variant 2: Implementation Roadmap

Intelligent Automation: From First Pilot to Enterprise Scale

Phase 1 — Foundation (Months 1–3) - Audit data quality across target automation domains; identify and remediate gaps - Map the five highest-volume, lowest-complexity processes in your highest-cost function - Select platform: Microsoft Power

Automate (248% ROI, payback <6 months — Forrester 2024), UiPath (97% ROI — Forrester 2024), Automation Anywhere, or ServiceNow depending on existing infrastructure - Establish governance framework: decision audit trails, exception handling, human escalation pathways

Phase 2 — Proof of Value (Months 4–6) - Deploy rules-based RPA on one or two bounded, high-volume processes - Instrument KPIs from day one: cycle time, error rate, hours recovered, cost per transaction - Run parallel human/automated processing for 4–6 weeks before full handover

Phase 3 — Scale and Extend (Months 7–18) - Extend proven automation to adjacent processes; add NLP/ML layers for judgment-based tasks - Introduce generative AI workflow tools (Microsoft 365 Copilot, Salesforce Agentforce) for knowledge worker productivity - Evaluate agentic AI for multi-step, variable processes once rules-based layer is stable

Phase 4 — Continuous Improvement (Month 18+) - Track EBIT attribution; benchmark against McKinsey high-performer threshold (5%+ EBIT impact) - Introduce AI governance tooling (IBM watsonx.governance) as agent complexity increases

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graph LR
    A[Phase 1\nFoundation\nMonths 1–3] --> B[Phase 2\nProof of Value\nMonths 4–6]
    B --> C{Gate:\nROI Verified?}
    C -->|Yes| D[Phase 3\nScale & Extend\nMonths 7–18]
    C -->|No| B2[Refine Scope\n& Retry]
    B2 --> B
    D --> E[Phase 4\nContinuous Improvement\nMonth 18+]
    style A fill:#1a5276,color:#fff
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    style D fill:#1a5276,color:#fff
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Key milestones: Phase 1 — data audit complete, governance framework documented; Phase 2 — first process live, KPIs instrumented; Phase 3 — 5+ processes automated, generative AI layer introduced; Phase 4 — EBIT attribution tracked.

Vendor Comparison

PLATFORM	3-YEAR ROI	PAYBACK PERIOD	PRIMARY USE CASES	AGENTIC AI CAPABILITY
Microsoft Power Automate	248%	<6 months	Finance, HR, operations automation	Via Copilot Studio agents
UiPath	97%	~12 months	RPA, IDP, document processing	UiPath Agent Platform (2025)
Automation Anywhere	Not publicly disclosed	Not disclosed	Insurance, banking, back-office	Automation Co-Pilot
ServiceNow	310% (healthcare)	<6 months	ITSM, HR, cross-enterprise workflows	Now Assist AI agents
Salesforce Agentforce	Not disclosed	Not disclosed	CRM, customer service, sales	Natively agentic

Sources: Forrester TEI for Microsoft Power Automate (2024); Forrester TEI for UiPath (2024); ServiceNow case study (2024/2025); Salesforce customer stories (2025). ROI figures from independent Forrester TEI studies where available.

Variant 3: Board Report

AI and Intelligent Automation — Board Briefing

Date: March 2026

Strategic Context

Intelligent automation is no longer a competitive advantage for early movers. It is table stakes. 88% of organisations now use AI in at least one function (McKinsey, 2025). The minority achieving measurable EBIT impact — 39% — have done so by treating automation as enterprise infrastructure, not technology experimentation.

The Investment Case

- Companies with fully AI-led processes achieve **2.5x higher revenue growth** and **2.4x greater productivity** than peers (Accenture, 2024)
- Productivity growth in AI-exposed industries has nearly **quadrupled** (7% to 27%) between 2018–2022 and 2018–2024 (PwC, 2025)
- Average enterprise AI investment: USD 130 million (KPMG, Q3 2025)
- Gartner projects the hyperautomation software market will reach **USD 1.04 trillion by 2026**

Documented Peer Outcomes

ORGANISATION	PLATFORM	OUTCOME	SOURCE
JPMorgan Chase	COiN (NLP)	360,000 hours/year saved	ABA Journal, 2023
BBVA	ChatGPT Enterprise	2.8 hrs/week per employee; 80% legal efficiency gains	OpenAI, 2025
Walmart	Self-Healing Inventory	USD 55M saved	Logistics Viewpoints, 2025
Allianz Australia	Project Nemo	7 days → <1 day (claims)	Allianz, 2025
Deloitte	UiPath	4M+ labour hours saved	UiPath case study

Sources: ABA Journal (2023); OpenAI (2025); Logistics Viewpoints (2025); Allianz Media Centre (2025); UiPath (2024)

Risk Factors Requiring Board Attention

1. **Data debt**: USD 1.5–2 trillion in accumulated technical debt across the Global 2000 (HFS Research, 2025). AI projects fail on data quality, not model capability.
2. **Governance gap**: Only one in five companies has a mature governance model for autonomous AI agents. Regulatory risk increases as agent autonomy increases.
3. **Abandonment rate**: 42% of companies scrapped most AI initiatives in 2025 (up from 17% in 2024). Failure is most common where strategy is unclear and data foundations are weak.

Board-Level Questions

1. Has management defined a measurable EBIT target for our AI programme?
2. What is our current data quality maturity score, and what investment is planned to improve it?
3. Has an AI governance policy been reviewed and approved at board level?

Variant 4: Team Update

AI Automation Wins — What Peers Are Achieving and What We Should Know

The evidence from 2024–2025 makes it clear: intelligent automation is delivering results in specific, documented ways. Here is what the most relevant company examples show:

Where the wins are happening:

- **Finance teams**: BBVA automated 9,000+ routine legal queries per year using ChatGPT Enterprise, freeing three staff members who now produce 11,000 documents instead. Deloitte saved 4 million+ labour hours by automating 600+ internal processes with UiPath.
- **Operations and claims**: Allianz processes 49.7% of pet insurance claims with zero human involvement. Asia's largest insurer automated 80% of manual processes across six departments — turn-around times cut by 50%.
- **Supply chain and logistics**: Walmart's inventory AI saved USD 55 million. UPS's ORION route AI eliminated 100 million delivery miles per year. DHL achieved 35% productivity uplift in automated warehouses.
- **Knowledge work**: Microsoft 365 Copilot at Vodafone saves 3 hours per employee per week — roughly 10% of a working week, back in each person's hands.

What the failures look like (so we avoid them):

95% of enterprise generative AI pilots fail to deliver P&L impact. The reasons are not the AI — they are: data that is not clean or structured enough for automation to act on; legacy systems that the automation cannot connect to; no governance framework to catch errors.

The companies with the best results started small (one bounded process, one department), proved the ROI in 6–12 months, then scaled. They also invested in data quality before the automation went live — not after.

Next Steps for Our Team: 1. Identify our three most repetitive, high-volume processes and bring them to the next planning session 2. Have IT assess current data quality in those processes — is it structured and machine-readable? 3. Review Microsoft Power Automate options — Forrester's independent study found 248% ROI and under 6 months to payback for enterprise deployments

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